



# The Land of Morning Freshness

A 10-DAY OBSERVATIONAL JOURNEY  
THROUGH THE DPRK

A 20-person expedition moving from the impeccably rebuilt streets of Pyongyang to the pristine mountains of the provinces, culminating at the Russian border. A ground-level look at daily life, culture, and nature beyond the headlines.



# The Itinerary



**Field Note:** The journey concludes with a 6-hour bus ride from Tumangan back into Vladivostok.





# Pyongyang: The City Risen from Ashes

## Historical Context

During the Korean War, Pyongyang was leveled; only the East and West gates survived. Everything visible today is entirely rebuilt.

**Absolute Cleanliness:**  
Not a single piece of  
litter on the streets.

**Urban Greenery:** Dense  
planting of fan-leaved ginkgo,  
conifers, and apricot trees  
with whitewashed trunks.

**The Vantage Point:** The 38th  
floor of the Yanggakdo ("Ram's  
Horn") International Hotel on  
the Taedong River.



**Absolute Cleanliness:**  
Not a single piece of litter  
on the streets.



# Daily Life & Style in the Capital

A comparison of strict traditions and unexpected modern conveniences.

## Personal Style



**Women:** Bright, embroidered blouses & parasols. Strict dark blue suits for officials.

**Men:** Fine cotton shirts and dark blue trousers.

## Street Transit



**Black:** Military

**Blue:** State

**Yellow:** Private



Private cars are abundant, and electric bicycles are rapidly rising in popularity.

## The Denim Rule



Jeans are present, but short or torn denim is strictly prohibited.



## The Metro Paradox

Passengers seamlessly pay using smartphone QR codes, yet the ornate metro carriage doors are opened entirely by hand.





# The DPRK Life Cycle: Milestones & Traditions



## Birth & Infancy

The 90-Day Rule: Infants are strictly isolated and not shown to outsiders for the first 90 days.

## First Birthday

Celebrated with massive scale. Families host lavish restaurant banquets inviting 100 to 300 guests.

## Marriage

Mandatory parental approval. State housing provided rapidly (e.g., apartment granted 10 days post-wedding). Divorce is exceptionally rare.

## The Elders

Grand, state-recognized celebratory banquets are held for 60th and 70th birthdays.



# Monuments & Marvels: A Curated Tour

## The Underground



Metro Museum & Small Mosaics. The country is 80% granite/marble. Stations feature brilliant small mosaics of Korean painting.

## The Ideology



Towering bronze statues of Kim Il-sung and Kim Jong-il, and the monumental Juche Tower overlooking the city.

## The Education



District Model Schools. Spotless facilities, taxidermy biology labs, and free afternoon clubs where high-school girls sing.

## The Entertainment



The National Circus. Featuring elite equilibrists, acrobats, and meticulously trained animals.



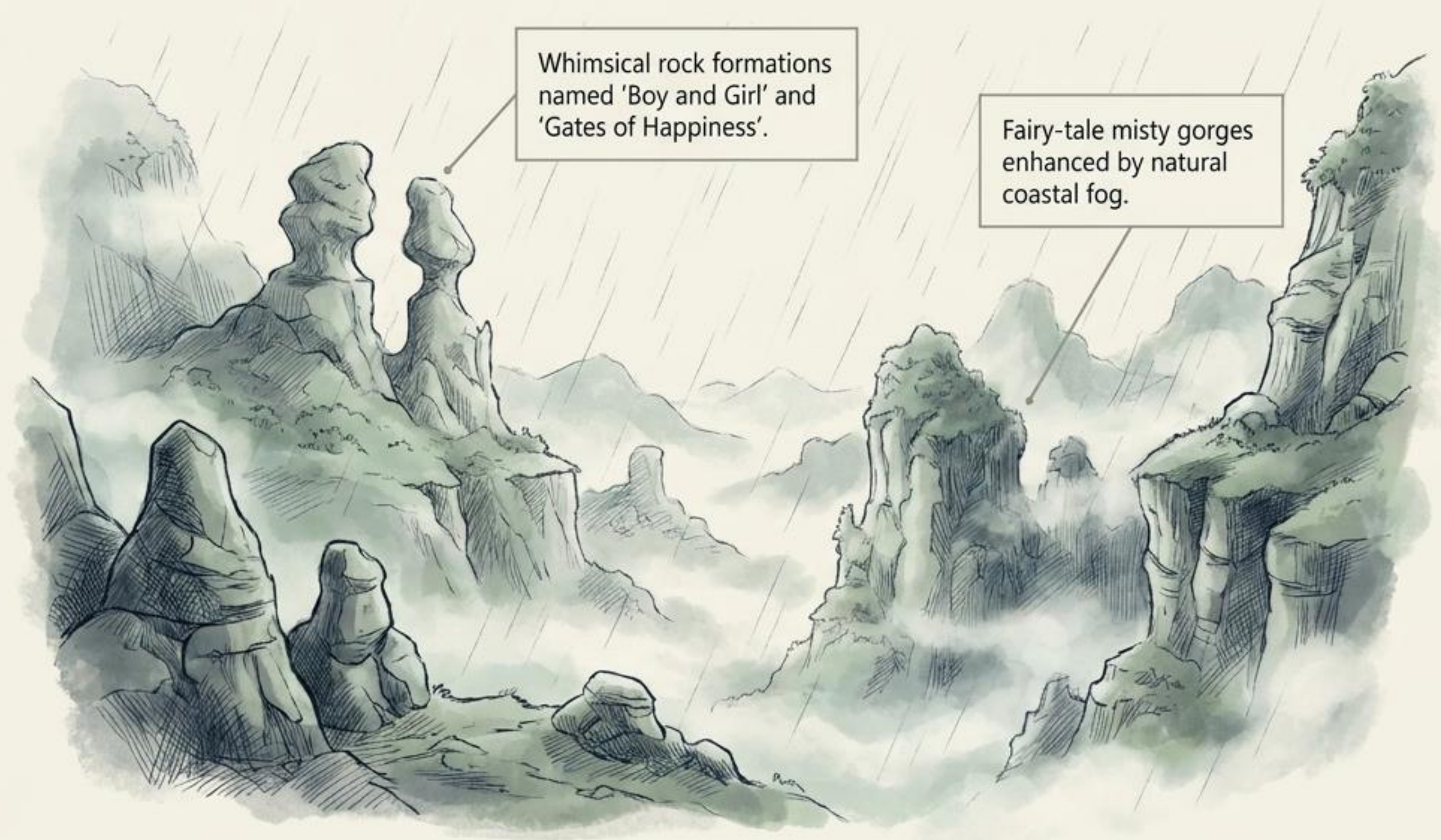
# Into the Provinces: Mount Chilbo

## The Journey

A domestic flight to Orang (delayed due to dense mountain fog), followed by a 3-hour bus ride through impeccable landscapes.

## Agriculture & Architecture

Perfectly tended, weed-free fields of rice, soy, and corn surround white stone houses with traditional tiled roofs.



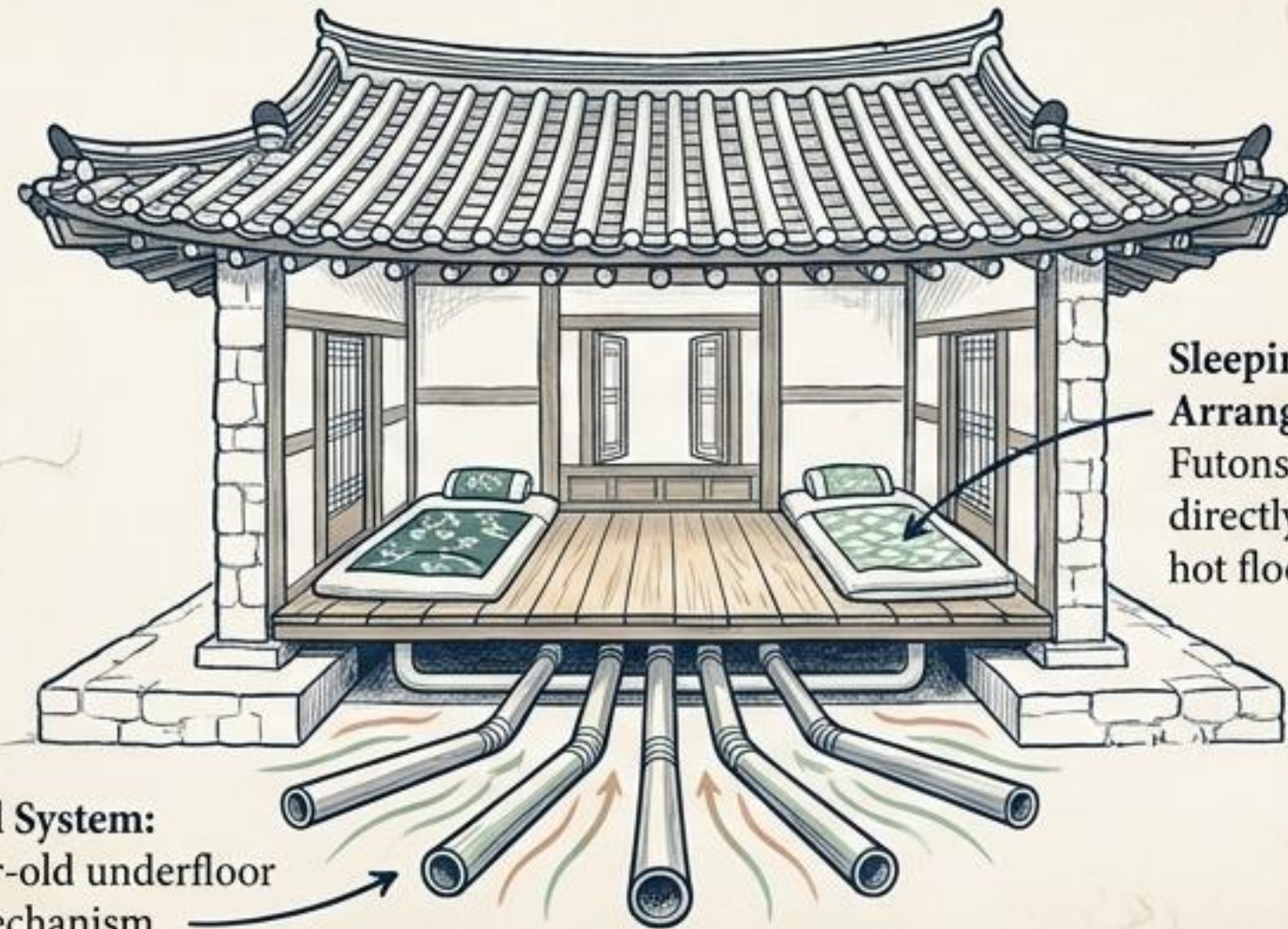
Whimsical rock formations named 'Boy and Girl' and 'Gates of Happiness'.

Fairy-tale misty gorges enhanced by natural coastal fog.



# Village Immersion: Life on the Coast

## Anatomy of a Homestay



**The Ondol System:**  
A 500-year-old underfloor heating mechanism.

**Sleeping Arrangements:**  
Futons placed directly on notably hot floors.

## Village Activities



**Culinary Masterclasses**  
Learning to make 'okso' (starch noodles) and sweet sticky rice dishes.



**Entertainment**  
Late evenings playing the traditional 'Yut' board game.



**Mornings**  
Slim Korean hostesses serving morning ginseng or barley tea with pancakes.



# Healing & Heritage: Kenson to Rason

## Kenson: Healing & Heritage



### Radon Springs

- Historical hot springs used by Korean kings, now a large sanatorium featuring warm water ponds.



### Agriculture

- Advanced greenhouse complexes successfully growing tomatoes, cucumbers, and bananas in North Korea.

## Rason: Free Economic Zone



### Industry with a Human Face

- Bustling garment factories where seamstresses hang photos of their own children at their workstations.



### Civic Life

- Thriving community spaces, including mini-zoos, art galleries, and taekwondo centers.



# Culinary Footprint

## Plating Diagram

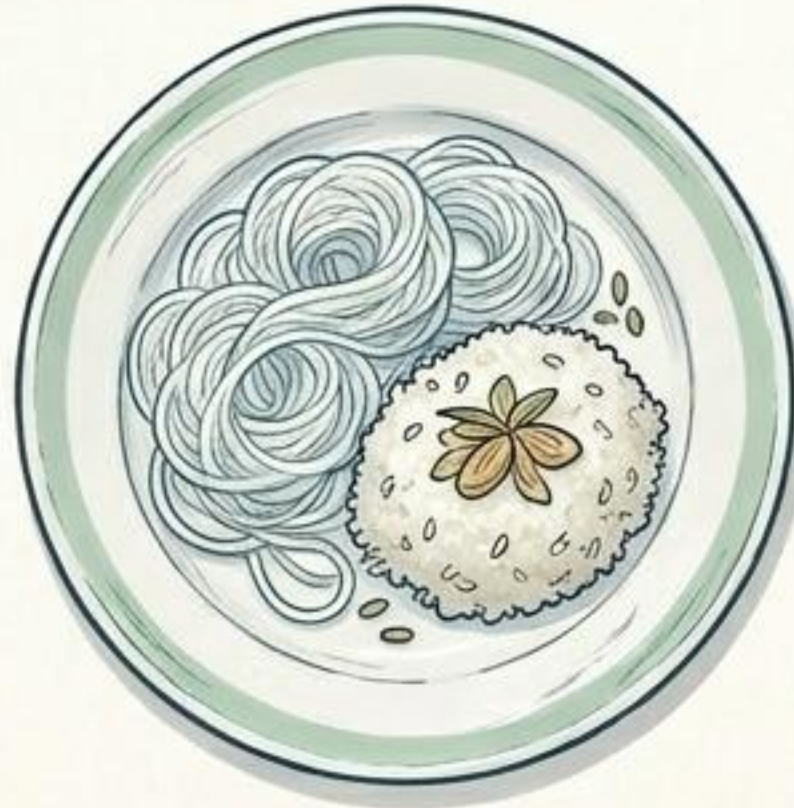


### Coastal Seafood

Freshly caught crab, scallops, sea urchin roe, flounder, and trout.

### Traditional Sweets

Sweet sticky rice and intricate starch noodles ('okso').



### Homestay Staples

Outdoor BBQs seasoned with highly popular local dry spice mixes.



### The 'Sweet Soup' Context

An objective note: Dog meat utilizes a highly regulated specific breed, strictly reserved for rare special occasions under the euphemism 'sweet soup'.



# The Russian Connection



1

## Historical Memory

Impeccably maintained monuments to Soviet soldiers and Marina Tsukanova (Hero of Russia) in Changjon.



3

## Pop Culture

Late-night homestay campfires featuring Koreans enthusiastically singing hits by Russian pop stars Polina Gagarina and Oleg Gazmanov



2

## Linguistics

Children at a foreign language school in Rason reciting Lermontov's "The Lonely Sail Whitens" entirely from memory.



4

## Geography

The final border pavilion view at the the exact tri-junction of Russia, China, and the DPRK.

The Russian Connection



# Final Verdict: Beyond the News Lens



## 1. Absolute Cleanliness

Spotless environments from the capital streets to rural agricultural fields.



## 2. Child Development

Comprehensive, free education and afternoon clubs fostering immense talent.



## 3. Deep Hospitality

Guides who sing, dance, cook, and seamlessly solve logistical issues.



## 4. Pristine Nature

Intact, fairy-tale landscapes from misty gorges to waterfalls.



## 5. Surprising Comforts

500-year-old heated floors, quality fabrics, and modern QR-code payments.



## 6. Preservation of Memory

A deep, visible reverence for historical alliances and Soviet monuments.

**CONCLUSION:** The DPRK emerges not merely as a geopolitical abstraction, but as a green, strictly ordered, yet profoundly hospitable society rooted in deep traditions and surprising modernity.